

social network to try and rival Facebook. Launched in June 2011, Google+ provides the potential to post status updates, share pictures, create and join communities, and allow grouping of contacts into something called 'Circles'. Then there is Google Hangouts - the instant messaging and video calling platform which also spun off from Google+ originally and became a well adopted separate entity.

### What went down in History:

Remember Google Buzz? - the old social networking cum messaging and microblogging platform that Google briefly integrated into Gmail, Picasa and others? The one that let users share media, links, comments and the



The original features launched with Google+.

likes? Neither do we. Buzz was a short prologue before the story of Google+ and it was Google+ that kicked Buzz to the kerb. There was another kid on the block named Google Wave that received an almost similar treatment. Google Wave was a software framework that provided real-time collaborative editing online and was designed to merge popular communication features like IM, Wikis, email and social networking through a communications protocol. It received a warm welcome initially only to later find itself encumbered because of an invite system for using the service thus making it not easy for early adopters to communicate with their existing contacts. Eventually, Google halted standalone development for Wave. A collection of learnings from all of these defunct social platforms (including the popular Orkut) paved way for the creation of Google+ as we know it now.